

JUST AUTOS

Leave Approval Emails

Approving or declining leave on the Monday board now emails the applicant automatically — what changed, what to do differently, and how to fix a missing address.

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Leave approval emails — now live

What's changed. Deciding a leave application on the Monday **Payroll & Leave Applications** board now emails the person who applied. Approvals *and* declines. Nobody has to write that email any more.

Live from: 24 August 2026. **Applies to:** anyone who approves or declines leave — and to the office, because the applicant now hears back automatically.

Nothing was sent for past applications. On the first run the portal recorded the 16 applications already decided on the board and deliberately emailed none of them. Only decisions made from now on send anything.

1. What happens now

Trigger	The Leave Approved column on an application is set to Approved or Denied
Who gets it	The person who applied
How fast	Within 15 minutes
Copied in	Ryan — and a reply from the applicant goes to Ryan too
What's in it	Leave type, start and end dates, total days, and what to do next

If it's approved, the email tells them it's approved, lists the dates, and says payroll takes it from here — with a line asking them to speak to their manager if plans change or a detail looks wrong.

If it's declined, the email says the application wasn't approved on this occasion, **asks them not to take the leave**, and points them at their manager (or a reply, which reaches Ryan) to sort out other dates.

Declines are sent automatically too. If you decline something you have already talked through face to face, that person will still receive the written note. That's deliberate — it means nothing gets lost — but it's worth knowing before you press it.

2. What you need to do differently

Almost nothing. Decide leave where you always have — on the application, in the **Leave Applications** group. The email looks after itself.

There is one rule worth committing to memory:

Leave is approved on the application, not on a note.

The board is used for two different jobs. As well as leave applications, it carries the day-to-day notes — "*Kaleb left at 11am*", "*Ollie O – sick*", "*Public Holiday*", "*Easter Monday – all staff*", and the export row. Plenty of those are marked Approved as well.

Those notes email nobody, on purpose. Only an item that was in **Leave Applications** and had Approved (or Denied) pressed on it counts as a decision. If it were otherwise, staff would be getting "your leave application has been approved" for a note recording that they went home early — and everyone on the payroll for a public

holiday.

So: if you want the person told, decide it on **their application**. A line typed straight into one of the payroll groups will never send anything, no matter what its status says.

Changing your mind is fine. Flipping an item from Approved to Denied (or back) counts as a new decision and sends the matching email once. Nobody gets the same email twice.

3. When we don't have someone's email address

Applications sent in through the Leave Request form carry the applicant's address. Rows keyed in by hand usually don't — so the portal falls back to a **staff directory** it keeps of names and addresses, including the short forms that get typed on the board ("Chris R", "Matt K", "Ollie O").

If it still can't work out an address, it **emails Ryan once** with the applicant's name and the leave dates, and sends nothing to anyone else. It never guesses.

To fix one — either of these works:

1. Fill in the **Email Address** column on the Monday item, **or**
2. Add the name to **Settings** → **Leave Notifications** → **Staff directory** in the portal, spelled exactly as it appears on the board.

Then leave it alone. The email goes out at the next 15-minute run. **Do not re-approve the application** — it's already approved, and re-pressing the status isn't what makes the email send.

4. The screen in the portal

Settings → **Leave Notifications** (admin login). It holds:

- **The on/off switch** and the HR address that's copied on everything and receives replies.
- **Waiting on an email address** — every decided application the portal couldn't place. This is the to-do list; clearing it clears itself.
- **Staff directory** — the names and addresses, editable. Add, edit or remove.
- **Recent decisions** — the last 100, showing who was emailed, at what address, and whether it worked. Rows marked *Pre-existing* are the historical ones that were deliberately never emailed.
- **Dry run** — works out who *would* be emailed and **sends nothing**. Use it after editing the directory to check your work.
- **Run now** — does it for real, rather than waiting for the next quarter-hour.

Every email that goes out is also noted on the Monday item itself, so the record sits where you're already looking.

5. Two things it refuses to do

Both look like faults and aren't:

- **A misspelt company address is not used.** One application on the board reads `justaustos...` instead of `justautos...`. Mail to that address vanishes — no bounce anyone would notice — and everybody would believe the applicant had been told. The portal treats it as no address at all and asks for a correction instead.
- **A name it can't pin to one person is left alone.** A bare "Matt" could be three people. A row named "James, Kaleb, Graham, Dom and Tyronne" isn't one person's application at all. Rather than pick, it reports the name as unresolved.

6. If something looks wrong

What you see	What it usually is	What to do
Someone says they got nothing	Either the decision was made on a note rather than an application, or we have no address for them	Check Settings → Leave Notifications . If the person is under <i>Waiting on an email address</i> , add the address (§3). If they aren't listed at all, the decision was pressed on a note — decide it on their application.
Ryan gets "no email address for ..."	That name isn't in the directory and the item has no address	Add either one (§3). It sends itself afterwards. You only get that notice once per application.
An email went to an old address	The board or the directory holds a stale address	The item's Email Address column wins over the directory — correct whichever is wrong.
You need it to stop	—	Turn the switch off in Settings → Leave Notifications . It stops immediately; nothing queues up behind it.

7. Where to ask

Chris built and holds this. Ryan is the address on every email, so anything a staff member replies to lands with him.

Reference for the technically minded: Monday board "Payroll & Leave Applications" (`5027074711`); the portal checks it every 15 minutes; every decision, address and send is logged in the portal. Full detail is in the Handover, §7.17, and the staff-facing routine is in the Standard Operating Procedures, §9a — both at Admin → Library.